

Code of Conduct Policy

Effective Date: 01 January 2026

1. Purpose and Scope

This Code of Conduct defines the ethical standards, behaviours and responsibilities expected of all employees, contractors, interns, and representatives of the organization. It applies to all work-related activities, whether conducted on company premises, off-site, or through digital platforms.

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Promote integrity, professionalism, and accountability
- Maintain a safe, respectful and productive work environment
- Protect the organization's reputation, assets and stakeholders.

2. Compliance with Laws and Regulations

All individuals must comply with applicable laws, regulations, and industry standards always. This includes labour laws, safety regulations, data protection laws, and anti-corruption laws.

Employees must:

- Be aware of and understand laws relevant to their roles
- Report any suspected legal violations immediately
- Cooperate fully with lawful investigations

Non-compliance may lead to disciplinary action and potential legal consequences.

3. Respect in the Workplace

The organization is committed to maintaining a workplace founded on dignity, equality, and mutual respect.

Unacceptable behaviour includes:

- Harassment (verbal, physical or digital)
- Discrimination based on race, gender, age, religion, disability, or any protected status
- Bullying, intimidation or threats

Employees are expected to:

- Treat colleagues, clients and partners with respect
 - Promote inclusion and teamwork
 - Report inappropriate behaviour without fear of retaliation
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4. Protection and Proper Use of Company Property

Company property includes physical assets, digital systems, confidential data, intellectual property, and financial resources.

Employees must:

- Use company resources responsibly and strictly for business purposes
- Safeguard confidential and sensitive information
- Prevent loss, theft, damage or unauthorized access

Misuse or negligence may result in disciplinary or legal action.

5. Professionalism and Ethical Behaviour

Employees must demonstrate honesty, fairness, and accountability in all professional interactions.

This includes:

- Acting in the best interest of the organization
- Avoiding dishonest or misleading behaviour
- Maintaining confidentiality and trust

Professional conduct is expected both inside and outside the workplace when representing the organization.

6. Dress Code and Personal Appearance

Employees are expected to maintain a professional appearance that reflects positively on the organization.

Guidelines include:

- Wearing attire appropriate to the work environment and role.
 - Neat, clean, and respectful appearance
 - Compliance with safety or uniform requirements where applicable
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7. Attendance, Punctuality, and Work Commitment

Regular attendance and punctuality are essential for operational effectiveness.

Employees must:

- Report to work on time and be prepared to perform duties
- Follow established procedures for leave and absences
- Notify supervisors promptly of delays or emergencies

Repeated absenteeism or lateness may result in corrective action.

8. Corruption, Bribery, and Fraud

The organization has zero tolerance for corruption and unethical practices.

Employees must not:

- Offer or accept bribes, kickbacks or improper gifts
- Engage in fraud, embezzlement or falsification of records
- Abuse authority for personal gain

All suspected violations must be reported immediately.

9. Job Duties, Responsibilities, and Authority

Employees are expected to:

- Perform assigned duties competently and responsibly
- Follow lawful instructions from supervisors
- Respect organizational hierarchy and decision-making processes

Negligence or misuse of authority is strictly prohibited.

10. Conflict of Interest

A conflict of interest occurs when personal interests interfere with professional responsibilities.

Employees must:

- Avoid situations that compromise objectivity
- Disclose potential conflicts (financial, personal, or relational)
- Refrain from decisions where impartiality is affected

Management will review and address disclosed conflicts appropriately.

11. Collaboration and Teamwork

A collaborative work environment is essential to success.

Employees are expected to:

- Support teamwork and shared goals
 - Respect diverse perspectives and ideas
 - Resolve conflicts professionally and constructively
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12. Communication and Confidentiality

Effective communication must be:

- Clear, respectful, and honest
- Professional in tone, including emails and digital communication
- Mindful of confidentiality and data protection

Unauthorized sharing of confidential information is strictly prohibited.

13. Misuse of Benefits and Privileges

Company benefits, allowances, and privileges are provided for legitimate purposes.

Employees must not:

- Abuse leave, expense claims, or allowances
- Use benefits fraudulently or dishonestly
- Transfer benefits without authorization

Violations may result in repayment and disciplinary action.

14. Compliance with Company Policies

Employees are required to:

- Read, understand, and comply with all company policies
- Stay informed of updates and changes
- Seek clarification when unsure

Failure to follow policies does not excuse misconduct.

15. Reporting Violations

Employees are encouraged to report suspected violations of this Code.

Reports may be made to:

- Supervisors
- Human Resources
- Designated ethics or compliance officers

The organization prohibits retaliation against individuals who report concerns in good faith.

16. Data Privacy and Information Security

Employees must comply with data protection standards and ensure that personal and organizational data is handled securely.

- Access data only on a need-to-know basis
 - Avoid sharing sensitive data through unsecured channels
 - Report any data breaches immediately
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17. Non-Retaliation and Whistleblower Protection

Any employee raising concerns in good faith will be protected from retaliation.

- Retaliation will be treated as a serious violation
 - Anonymous reporting mechanisms may be used where available
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18. Policy Review and Amendments

The organization reserves the right to review and update this policy periodically.

- Employees will be informed of significant changes
 - Continued employment constitutes acceptance of updates
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19. Disciplinary Actions

Violations of this Code may result in disciplinary measures, including:

- Verbal or written warnings
- Suspension
- Termination of employment and legal action where applicable.